

Parent Guide — primary / module-05-dot-addition

IKS Curriculum

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Parent Guide — Module 5: Make Ten! (Towards Bindu Paddhati)

Your child's age: Primary (Grades 3–5) · **Module length:** 10 sessions × 35 min

What your child is learning

A foundational mental math skill called “**making 10**” — instantly knowing the partner of any digit that adds to 10: $- 1 + 9 = 10$ - $2 + 8 = 10$ - $3 + 7 = 10$ - $4 + 6 = 10$ - $5 + 5 = 10$

This is the building block for almost all mental arithmetic. By the end of the module your child should recall any partner in under a second.

At the end of the module (Day 6) they'll see a teacher-led demo of the older-grade technique called **Bindu Paddhati** (Sanskrit for “dot method”) — a clever way to add long columns of numbers fast. They won't learn it fully until Grade 6, but they'll see it once and be impressed.

What to expect this fortnight

A daily chant: > “1 and 9 make 10! 2 and 8 make 10! 3 and 7 make 10! 4 and 6 make 10! 5 and 5 make 10!”

Games at home: - A card-based “Make Ten” game (Day 1). - Quick-fire 10-pair drills with a parent or sibling. - An “Add 9” trick (Day 5): your child will add $33 + 9$ by doing $33 + 10 - 1 = 42$. Mental, fast.

A creative project (Days 7–10): Your child will design their own “Make 10” game — cards, board, dice, jumping game — and play classmates' games on Day 10.

How to help — and how NOT to help

Helpful: - 5-minute 10-pair drill before bed. Call out single digits; your child says the partner. Try to beat their time. - Try the “Add 9” trick yourself — see how much faster it is than column addition. Your child will love being faster than you. - For their project: provide materials (cards, paper, dice) and let *them* design the rules.

Not helpful: - Doing column addition the slow way and insisting that's the "right" way. The dot method is also right. - Designing their game for them. - Anxiety about speed. Speed comes from practice, not pressure.

A note on "Vedic mathematics"

You may have heard the term "Vedic mathematics." Here is the honest framing we use: - The "dot method" (Bindu Paddhati) is a real, useful Indian mental-arithmetic technique. - It is **not** found in any actual Vedic text — it was developed in the 20th century by teachers in India. - The math is real. The cultural achievement is real. The history is just more recent than the name suggests.

We teach the technique enthusiastically AND we are honest about its history. By Senior band (Grade 9–12) your child will read the scholarly debate about this and form their own view.

What success looks like

By the end of the module, your child can: - Recall all 5 ten-pairs instantly. - Add a small column of single digits by spotting 10-pairs first. - Do +9 mentally to any 2-digit number. - Show classmates a game they designed.

Want to go deeper?

The Middle-band version (Grade 6–8) teaches the full dot method on multi-digit columns. Preview: [curriculum/middle/module-05-dot-addition/README.md](#).

10-Day Lesson Plan

Module 5 (Primary) — 10-Day Lesson Plan

At a glance (35-min sessions)

Day	Title	Activity	Output
1	Make Ten Game	Pair card game	First-day fun
2	Bonds of Ten chant	Memorise pairs	Chant + recall
3	Find the Pair	Scanning drill	Worksheet
4	Add by Grouping	Column-addition game	First column wins
5	Add-9 Trick	Add 10, take 1	Drill sheet
6	Meet the Dot	Teacher demo of Bindu Paddhati	Awe
7	Make-a-Game Day	Design own game	Sketch + first prototype

Day	Title	Activity	Output
8	Project Day 1	Build the game	Game ready to play
9	Project Day 2	Finish + test	Play once
10	Game Showcase	Play each other's games	Stickers

Daily structure (35 min)

Time	What
5 min	Settle + the “Make 10!” chant
8 min	Story / new game introduction
17 min	Game / activity
5 min	Sharing / reset

The daily chant

“1 and 9 make 10! 2 and 8 make 10! 3 and 7 make 10! 4 and 6 make 10! 5 and 5 make 10!”

Sing it / chorus it with claps. By Day 3 it should be effortless.

Pacing notes

- Games > worksheets at this band. If a worksheet feels slow, drop it and add another game round.
- Day 6 (dot method demo) is a “wow” moment — keep it short and mysterious.
- Days 8–10 build to the game showcase. Confirm groups by Day 6.

What children leave with

- Instant recall of all 5 ten-pairs.
- A mental habit of looking for “easy groups” when adding.
- The Add-9 trick.
- Curiosity about the dot method.
- One game they made and one they played.